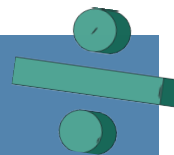




What is Algebra?



Algebra is a type of maths where the values in an equation are unknown. For example:

$$12 + \square = 19$$

In this case, we don't know what the second number in the equation is, so we put a $\square$ in the place where the number would go.

Here is another way to write the same equation:

$$12 + x = 19$$

We still don't know what the second number is, but this time we put a letter where the number would go instead.

You can use any letter or symbol instead of a number:

$$12 + a = 19 \quad 12 + j = 19 \quad 12 + \square = 19 \quad 12 + \text{😎} = 19$$

1	2	3	4	5
6	7	8	9	10
11	12	x	x	x
x	x	x	x	= 19

The idea of algebra is to work out what the unknown part of the equation is by using what you know about inverse operations.

$$12 + \text{😎} = 19$$

So...

$$\text{😎} = 19 - 12$$

$$\text{😎} = 7$$

